

Extemporaneous Guide — Talk No. 13

Can You Discern the Principle Behind the Law? — 24 minutes

One sentence: Mature obedience looks beneath a command to Jehovah's timeless thinking, then chooses the course that imitates the loving Person behind it.

Main memory path: HAND → HEART → PEACE → PURITY → LOYALTY → TRUTH → JUSTICE → LOVE → PERSON

Delivery rule: None of the cited scriptures is designated "Read" in the outline. Refer to and explain them briefly; do not create extra formal readings.

LAW AND PRINCIPLE — 3:00

HAND — What remains after the rule?

- Question: law tells **what**; what does principle do?
- Set Video 1: notice what remains when particular rule no longer applies.

VIDEO 1 — 08-CO-v26_E_131

Outline 2:04; actual file 2:05.

- Law = specific requirement.
- Principle = timeless truth / Jehovah's thinking.
- Child: avoid displeasing → understand and share parent's values.
- Psalm 119:104: understanding helps reject wrong course.
- Landing: **Knowing and loving Person makes heartfelt obedience easier.**

“YOU HEARD . . . HOWEVER, I SAY” — 18:00

HEART — Set the six-example lens

- Matthew 5:17-48: Jesus reveals truths behind Mosaic commands.
- Colossians 2:13, 14: Law covenant removed.
- Malachi 3:6: principles remain because Jehovah does not change.
- Repeated question: **What does this teach about Jehovah, and how should it shape me?**

1. PEACE — Murder

- Matthew 5:21-26: beneath murder → anger / contempt.
- Jehovah = God of peace; accountable for hatred where murder begins.
- Application: make peace quickly; initiate / private / calm / listen / apologise.
- Key question: **Not “Am I technically guilty?” but “How can I restore peace?”**

2. PURITY — Adultery

- Matthew 5:27-30: passionate disloyal look cultivates heart adultery.
- Jehovah = holy; marriage = loyal love.
- Decisive measures: reject pornography and temptation source.
- Positive side: contentment and affection for own mate.

3. LOYALTY — Divorce

- Matthew 5:31, 32: formal protection could be selfishly misused.
- Principle: selfish choice can endanger self/others spiritually.
- Application: don't give up quickly; seek help / communicate / forgive / make changes.
- Honour Creator of marriage; help family grow spiritually.

4. TRUTH — Oaths

- Matthew 5:33-37: impressive promise can hide unreliability.
- Impossible promise = immodest; false promise = dishonest.
- Jehovah = God of truth.
- Think before commitment; let simple **Yes** carry weight everywhere.

5. JUSTICE — Eye for eye

- Matthew 5:38-42: judicial proportional justice, not personal revenge.
- Jehovah = final Judge; wounded pride is not.
- 1 Peter 2:23: Jesus entrusted himself to righteous Judge.
- Set Video 2: minimum requirement → what love would do.

VIDEO 2 — 10-CO-v26_E_132

Outline 6:29; actual file 6:21.

- Unfair treatment / lost opportunity.
- First thought: minimum cooperation, no overt revenge.
- Meditates: love / second mile.
- Prays / gives notes / offers help / entrusts outcome.
- Key line: **“He did not merely suppress revenge; he replaced it with goodness.”**

6. LOVE — Enemies

- Matthew 5:43-48: “love neighbour” Scriptural; “hate enemy” was not.
- Father gives sun/rain even to opposers.
- 1 John 4:8, 19: Jehovah is love; we love because he loved first.
- No partiality / respectful / kind; do not let hostility dictate character.
- Romans 13:8-10: love fulfils Law.
- Matthew 28:19: Christian commands reflect Jehovah’s love.

LOVE THE PERSON BEHIND THE PRINCIPLE — 3:00

PERSON — Carry Jehovah's thinking with you

- Matthew 11:27: Jesus knows and reveals Father.
- Six examples reveal personality, not merely harder rules.
- Galatians 6:2: law of Christ also reveals loving Lawgiver.
- Key line: **“A principle shows the reason; the reason opens a window into Jehovah's thinking.”**
- Return to road-crossing image:
 - grown child no longer needs hand rule;
 - respect for life and guidance remains.
- Maturity ≠ independence from Jehovah.
- Maturity = carry his thinking where no detailed rule gives every step.
- Pray; Proverbs 2:4, 9; ask:
 1. What does this reveal about Jehovah?
 2. Which choice would imitate him?
- Final line: **“Discern the principle, imitate the Person behind it, and enjoy the happiness of thinking like Jehovah.”**

Timing control

Clock	Be here	If running long
0:25	Start Video 1	Use one setup question
2:35	Define law/principle	One sentence each
3:00	Start six examples	Keep exact transition question
4:30	Adultery	One principle + two applications
6:05	Divorce	Do not retell publication details
7:45	Oaths	Keep “Yes” application
9:10	Eye for eye	Preserve judicial/personal distinction
10:15	Start Video 2	Actual playback about 6:21
16:45	Explain video	Keep prayer + proactive goodness
18:20	Love enemies	Do not skip Father’s example
21:00	Final section	Return to first video image
23:35	Begin final sentence	Finish cleanly at 24:00

If short: Pause after each principle and ask the repeated Jehovah question.

If long: Trim applications to slash-separated cue words; never rush either video or omit one of the six laws.